

University Hospital Physical Medicine & Rehabilitation Clinic
Clinic Phone: 214-645-2080

September 8, 2025

Patient Name: Kathryn Copeland
DOB: June 28, 1985

RE: Medical Statement for Disability Application

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing this statement in support of Kathryn Copeland's application for Social Security Disability Insurance and Supplemental Security Income. She has been under my care at UTSouthwestern since October 8, 2024, for Hypermobility EhlersDanlos Syndrome (hEDS), Mast Cell Activation Syndrome (MCAS) and Postural Orthostatic Tachycardia Syndrome (POTS). These are severe chronic illnesses that significantly impair her daily functioning and ability to sustain employment.

In addition to these primary conditions, review of her medical records shows she is also being treated for the following chronic and compounding illnesses: Long COVID, Median Arcuate Ligament Syndrome (MALS), a vestibular schwannoma (brain tumor), Hashimoto's disease with severely low iron requiring three iron infusions, bilateral vision loss and binocular dysfunction linked to toxic mold exposure, depression, post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), and immune abnormalities including hypogammaglobulinemia.

Her July 2025 evaluation by Dr. Alfred Johnson documented toxic mold exposure with extremely elevated levels of Aspergillus, Chaetomium, and Stachybotrys. He noted severe chronic fatigue (up to 18 hours/day bedridden), 30 lbs of weight loss, cognitive impairment, and hyperbaric oxygen therapy and urgent need for relocation.

Since my prior March 2025 statement, Ms. Copeland's health has further deteriorated. She was displaced in June/July 2025 due to mold contamination and has been forced to live in a hotel. This unstable housing situation prevents her from accessing home health nursing and supportive services previously prescribed, further worsening her decline.

She continues to experience severe and disabling symptoms, including:

- Severe systemic inflammation.

- Persistent fatigue and post-exertional malaise.
- Orthostatic intolerance, dizziness, tremors, and frequent migraines.
- Neurological and sensory issues, including visual disturbances and light sensitivity.
- Severe GI impairment with ongoing nutritional instability.
- Cognitive dysfunction, including impaired memory, slowed processing, and executive dysfunction.

Her PROMIS-29 scores from September 2025 confirm extremely poor physical function, high fatigue, high pain interference, and significant mood symptoms. Despite treatment efforts, her condition remains chronic, disabling, and unlikely to improve.

Without access to disability benefits, Ms. Copeland is unable to secure safe housing, purchase adequate food, obtain necessary medications, or pay for transportation to medical appointments. This lack of resources is directly worsening her health and preventing her from accessing prescribed care.

In my professional opinion, Ms. Copeland remains unable to perform sustained work activity and is in urgent need of financial and medical support to stabilize her living conditions and prevent irreversible decline.

Sincerely,

 9/10/25

Isabel Huang, MD
UT Southwestern Medical Center